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First Principles of Customer Research — How to quickly find out what you really need to know



Stefano Bellucci Sessa

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Experiments in Design is our monthly Service Design meetup at Fluxx HQ. This time Rupert Tebb and Richard Edgley talked about what makes user research effective and insightful and Alice Wilkie explained how Fluxx used research and experiments to improve the customer experience for a Dubai bank.



PRINCIPLES

2 RUPERT TEBB @rupert_Tebb

😊 #1 START WITH CUSTOMER NEED

#2 GET THE RIGHT SAMPLE



⚠️ #3 PAY ATTENTION TO PEOPLE'S BEHAVIOURS
→ they lie! ←

↔ #4 EXAMINE THE WIDER CONTEXT ↔



#5 FOSTER EMPATHY BETWEEN THE TEAM & USER

Read Rupert's medium post at bit.ly/29XI4RY

#6 RESEARCH IS A TEAM SPORT

#7 SPEND LOTS OF TIME SHOWING RESEARCH

#8 CUMULATIVE NOT SUMMATIVE

WHAT MAKES GOOD INSIGHT?

RICHARD EDGLEY
@RichardEdgley

"You never really know a man until you understand things from his point of view, until you climb into his skin and walk around in it."



- 1** BE BASED ON A FIRST PERSON EXPERIENCE
get into their shoes 
- 2** AHA-FRESH PERSPECTIVE
ON SOMETHING IMPLICIT AT ALL THE TIME 
- 3** BASED ON TRUTH, NEED & TENSION
being provocative is a good thing
- 4** BE TARGETED
focus on a specific sample 
- 5** SUGGEST AN IDEA OR IDEAS 
- 6** IT'S OK TO BE ~~WRONG~~
keep researching, experimenting & learning
- REMEMBER THAT:**
- 🕒 Insights aren't an exact science
 - 🔍 We are looking for insights, not proof

CASE STUDY

DUBAI BANK

ALICE WILKIE
@Alice_Wilkie


ARAB & INDIAN
EXPATS

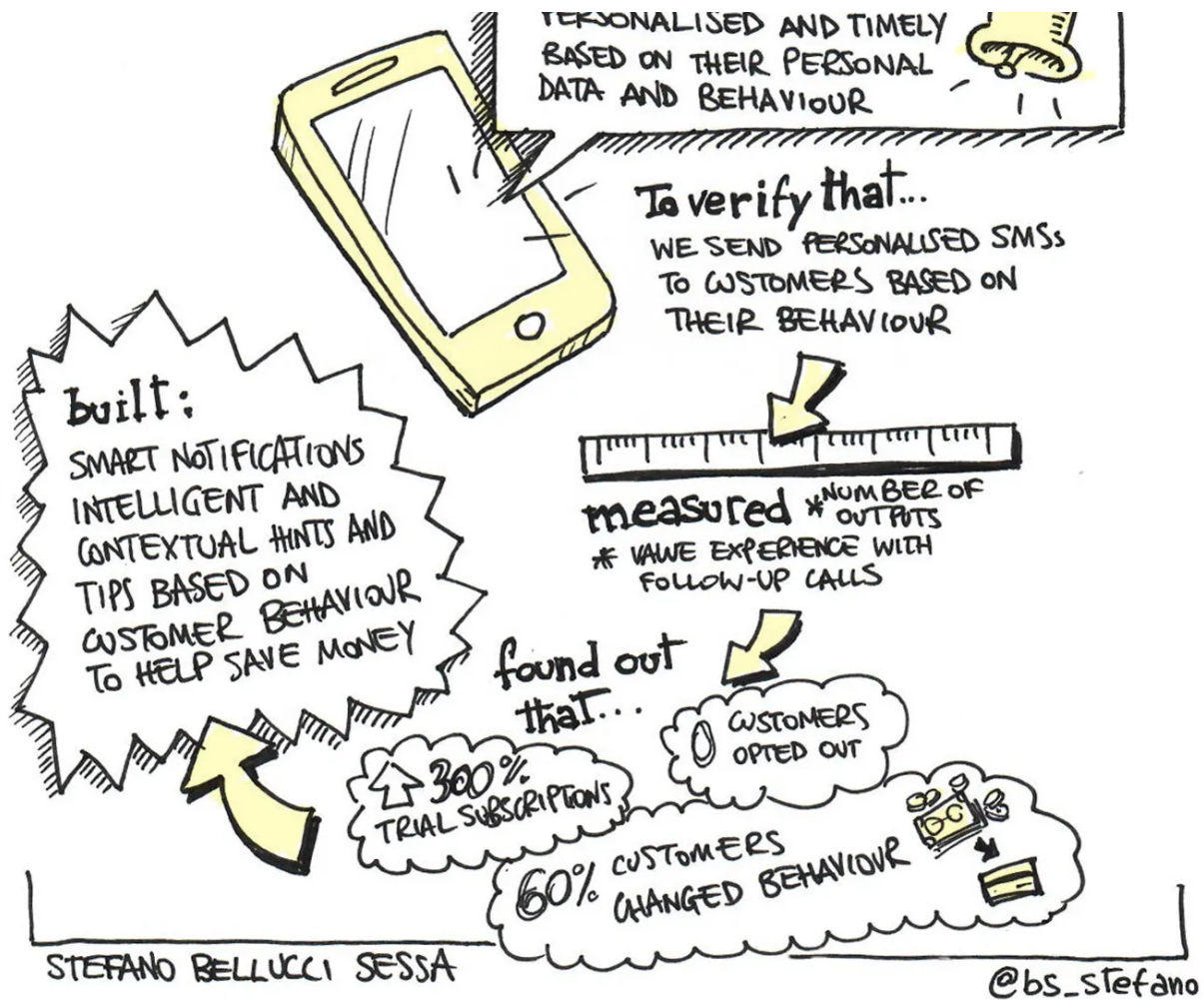
We like the SMS notifications
currently offered by banks

EXPERIMENT

We believe that...

CUSTOMERS WOULD REACT
POSITIVELY TO SMARTPHONE
NOTIFICATIONS THAT ARE





Do you want to learn how to draw? Start from my article:

Sketching for people who really can't draw

Recently I ran a drawing workshop for my colleagues at Fluxx. A few days later one of them was able to draw this:

medium.com

Stefano Bellucci Sessa is a Designer at Fluxx, a company that uses experiments to understand customers, helping clients to build better products. We work with organisations such as Lloyds Bank, Royal Society of Arts, the Parliamentary Digital Service and William Hill.

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How to use empathy in design without killing millions of women by Rupert Tebb
Innovation in the Middle East: 48 things I learned while designing a new bank in Dubai by Alice Wilkie.

To find out more about Fluxx's next Experiment in Design event, visit our Meetup page.

Design

UX

Sketchnoting

Banking

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